

The Sūtra of Individual Liberation for Fully Ordained Nuns

Bhikṣuṇī Prātimokṣa Sūtra · Toh 4 · Derge Kangyur

དག་སྒྲོལ་མཁ་སི་སོ་རོ་ཐར་པའི་མཛོད་

Toh 4 in the Kangyur is the Bhikṣuṇī Prātimokṣa Sūtra, known in Tibetan as the Dge slong ma'i so sor thar pa'i mdo, or in English as the Sūtra of Individual Liberation for Fully Ordained Nuns. It is a Vinaya text — a code of monastic discipline — setting out the rules of individual liberation, the prātimokṣa, specifically for fully ordained Buddhist nuns, the bhikṣuṇīs. The text opens with verses of homage to the Buddha, Dharma, and Saṅgha before proceeding to enumerate the precepts that govern the conduct and spiritual life of nuns within the monastic community. As one of the foundational disciplinary scriptures, it belongs to the Vinaya section of the Kangyur, the collection of texts attributed to the Buddha himself.

In the language of India: Bhikṣuṇī Prātimokṣa Sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Sūtra of Individual Liberation for Fully Ordained Nuns. First fascicle.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

I bow to the buddha, sole guide of beings, to the sacred Dharma, and to the noble Saṅgha — precious jewels. Now listen with effort as I set forth individual liberation, the cause of complete freedom from suffering.

Whose banner of renown resounds through the three worlds, who has proclaimed the sound of the sacred Dharma like the roar of a lion, who has attained the omniscient treasure-store of the Jewel — at whose feet Brahmā and Indra (Śakra) touch their crown-jewels in reverence, who has crossed the fathomless and boundless ocean of suffering — I bow my head to that sovereign of beings, and shall open the training-foundation of omniscience, that precious vessel, in the midst of the noble assembly.

The very heart and essence of all that abides in the great ocean of the Buddha's Vinaya — fathomless and without boundary — is this individual liberation.

This is the supreme guide of all phenomena under the sovereignty of the sacred Dharma-king. This is the great market-treasury of training, the trading-house of the community of monks. This is the medicine that clears the

poison of those seized by broken moral discipline. This is the iron hook for young two-legged beings who have strayed in the intoxication of youth. This is the method of crossing over to liberation from saṃsāra — deeper than any ocean. This is the sure and solid bridge for beings traveling the path of good rebirth. This is the path that defeats the afflictions, the supreme guide for the sovereign. This is the foundation — like a stairway — for entering the city of liberation.

"When I have passed into nirvāṇa, this shall be your Teacher." With reverence, the Self-Arisen One himself extolled it with care before the assembled community of monks.

Even the very word "buddha" is exceedingly rare in the worlds. To obtain human birth is extremely rare. Going forth into renunciation is extremely rare. And for those who have gone forth, perfection in moral discipline is extremely rare. Even if one's moral discipline is wholly pure, finding a good spiritual companion is very hard indeed.

The arising of a buddha in the world, the teaching of the Dharma, the obtaining of good moral discipline, and the finding of a good companion — though rare — having now obtained them all: wise ones who wish me well, wishing to make these fruitful, should strive to listen to individual liberation for the sake of those committed to their vows.

The monk who has subdued the passions and tamed every sense faculty, who has gone forth and does not waver from buddhahood, who wishes for certain liberation — let such a one always guard the individual liberation.

Even across countless aeons, to hear individual liberation, to retain and hold it in mind — this is rare; and to put it into practice is rarer still.

Blissful is the arising of buddhas. Blissful is the teaching of the Dharma. Blissful is the harmony of the Saṅgha. Blissful is the austerity of those in harmony. Blissful is the sight of the noble ones. Blissful is the company of the holy. Were the childish ones never to be seen, one would dwell in constant happiness. Blissful is the sight of those endowed with moral discipline. Blissful is the sight of the learned. Blissful is the sight of arhats who are freed from rebirth, those foe-destroyers. Blissful is a pleasant ford, blissful is a pleasant river-stream. Blissful is one who is habituated to the Dharma. Blissful is one who has obtained wisdom. Blissful is the exhaustion of conceit and arrogance.

Those who are disciplined, with tamed faculties, who grow old in peaceful hermitages, and the learned who dwell within the forests, their youth spent — blissful is the dwelling of those whose youth has passed.

Noble ones, what has gone by among your seasons, and what remains — only so much remains. Noble ones, old age and death are coming and will be manifested, and the teaching of the Teacher will also fall into ruin. The Mount Meru of the Dharma will crumble. The wish-fulfilling tree of the Dharma will wither. The wheel of the Dharma will decay. The lamp of the Dharma will be extinguished.

The ocean of Dharma, too, will dry up. The darkness of ignorance will grow ever more powerful. The practice of striving will utterly decline, and without those who strive, before long this world will be without light. Therefore, noble ones, practice yoga with diligence.

The awakening of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas, and likewise all other virtuous qualities akin to that — the qualities on the side of awakening — are attained through diligence. The Saṅgha of śrāvakas of the Blessed One have few concerns and few activities, so what is the first business of the Saṅgha? Noble ones, ask those who have not yet arrived about their aspiration and their purification, and having asked, let it be declared.

With ten fingers joined in reverence
before the Śākya Lion,
recite the Prātimokṣa
and hear it from me for the sake of those to be tamed.
Having heard, strive to accomplish
exactly as the great seer taught,
and with respect to the minor infractions,
make them as things you actually do.

For the mind-horse that is hard to bridle,
always striving to go astray,
this thread — the Prātimokṣa —
is the sharp, hundredfold fitting nail.

Those great ones who are turned back
and do not transgress their bounds by word alone —
they are good human horses
who will certainly be victorious in the battle with afflictions.

Those who lack this thread
and will never wish for it —
they will be roiled by the battle of afflictions
and will wander utterly without rest.

Noble ones of the Saṅgha, please listen. Today is the fourteenth or fifteenth day of the Saṅgha's restoration ceremony (poṣadha). If the time has come for the Saṅgha and it meets with approval, let the Saṅgha grant permission: today the Saṅgha shall perform the restoration ceremony and recite the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra. This is the motion.

Noble ones, we shall perform the restoration ceremony. I shall recite the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra. Listen well and take it thoroughly to heart, and I will explain it to you. Whoever among you has a transgression, let her confess it. If there is no transgression, remain silent. If you remain silent, I shall understand, noble ones, that you are completely pure. Just as a nun answers when questioned individually, so too shall this assembly of nuns be proclaimed to up to three times. Further, any nun who, when it has been proclaimed up to three times before an assembly of nuns such as this, has a transgression and yet does not confess it while being mindful of it — that one speaks a conscious lie. Noble ones, speaking a conscious lie has been declared by the Blessed One to be an obstructing factor. Therefore, a nun who wishes to be fully purified of a transgression that has occurred and who, being mindful of it, perceives a transgression, should confess it. Having confessed, she will abide in touch with ease. If she does not confess and does not purify, it will not be so.

Noble ones, I have set forth the introduction to the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra. I now ask you, noble ones: are you completely pure in this? Are you completely pure in this? I ask this a second and a third time. Noble ones, since you are completely pure in this and remain silent in this way, so it is understood to be.

In summary:

Unchastity, stealing,
killing a human, speaking falsehood,
the child of a sākha, the perfume-selling youth,
the intimate friend, and the person born of a slave.

Noble ones, these eight rules leading to defeat arise from the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra, which is proclaimed twice each month.

Furthermore, if any nun who has come to share the same training as the community of nuns, without having surrendered her training and without having declared the training impaired, engages in unchaste conduct — the practice of sexual intercourse — even with a creature born in an animal's womb, that nun too has incurred defeat and must not remain in the community.

Furthermore, if any nun takes what has not been given by others, whether dwelling in a village or dwelling in a wilderness — takes it in a manner that counts as theft — then to whatever extent she has taken without it being given, if she is seized by a king or a great minister, who says to her: "Woman, you are a thief, a fool, an idiot, a robber," and she is executed, bound, or banished — if a nun thus takes what has not been given, that nun too has incurred defeat and must not remain in the community.

Furthermore, if any nun, with deliberate intent, takes the life of a human being or of one who has the form of a human, either with her own hand or by providing a weapon to that person, or by seeking out a weapon that will be used against that person, or by inducing that person to die, or by praising death to that person — saying such words as: "O person, what use to you is this evil, impure, and wretched life? For you, death is better than living" — and, through the desire of her mind and the conceptual thoughts of her mind, in many and various ways induces that person to die or praises death to that person, and the person addressed by such instigation thereby dies, that nun too has incurred defeat and must not remain in the community.

Furthermore, if any nun who has no direct knowledge and no full knowledge of the supremely excellent qualities of a human being — whether noble attainment, realization, knowledge, vision, or meditative experience — nevertheless claims, "I know this, I see this," and from that a transgression arises; and then, wishing to purify it, at some other time, whether asked or not, she says: "Noble ones, I said I knew without actually knowing; I said I saw without actually seeing — I spoke an idle, false boast," then, save for the conceit of pride, that nun too has incurred defeat and must not remain in the community.

Furthermore, if any nun who has become impassioned, together with a man who has become impassioned, offers, presents, and causes him to experience contact from the eye downward and the knee upward, that nun too has incurred defeat and must not remain in the community.

Furthermore, if any nun who has become impassioned, together with a man who has become impassioned, acts in a manner involving any of the following eight bases while directing her body toward a place that a man could approach a woman — concealment, tossing and swaying, fondling, moving toward a locality, giving a signal or sign, welcoming a man's coming and going, making him her own, or directing her body toward such a place — if a nun does such a thing at any of these eight bases, that nun too has incurred defeat and must not remain in the community.

Furthermore, if any nun, knowing that a certain other nun has committed an act leading to defeat, conceals it; and then when that nun has fallen into decline, or died, or wandered away, or fled to another district or another region, that first nun says: "Noble ones, I knew from before how this nun had committed an act leading to defeat" — that nun too has incurred defeat and must not remain in the community.

Furthermore, if any nun takes the vows of one who is not worthy of receiving the prostration vow from a concordant community of nuns — vows given after a concordant community of monks has performed the act of suspension against a certain monk and that monk remains under suspension — and she causes her hair to stand on end, and her hair to be disheveled, and causes the community of monks grief, stirs them up, draws near to them in a comparable manner, stations herself within the boundary, and while knowing she should ask forgiveness, instead says: "Noble one, your hair has become disheveled —"

"— your hair has become disheveled; do not cause the community of monks to bristle with anger, do not stir them up, do not draw near to them in a comparable manner, do not station yourself within the boundary and ask forgiveness. I shall attend upon you, noble one, without any concern for whatever preoccupies you — your alms bowl, your monastic robes, your net, your cup, your belt, your recitation, your chanting, your yoga, your mental practice — and shall serve you free from attachment to whatever it may be."

If that nun says those words, the other nuns shall address her thus: "Noble one, you have received vows from a concordant community of nuns by which you are not worthy of receiving the prostration vow — this having been done after a concordant community of monks performed the act of suspension against a certain monk. Your hair has stood on end, your hair has become disheveled, you have caused the community of monks to bristle with anger,

you have stirred them up, you have drawn near to them in a comparable manner, you have stationed yourself within the boundary, and knowing you should ask forgiveness, you have instead said: 'Noble one, your hair has stood on end, your hair has become disheveled; do not cause the community of monks to bristle with anger, do not stir them up, do not draw near to them in a comparable manner, do not station yourself within the boundary and ask forgiveness. I shall attend upon you, noble one, without any concern for whatever preoccupies you — your alms bowl, your monastic robes, your net, your cup, your belt, your recitation, your chanting, your yoga, your mental practice — and shall serve you free from attachment to whatever it may be.' Do not say such a thing. Noble one, you should abandon this basis that follows in the direction of the act of suspension."

When the nuns have so instructed that nun, if she abandons that basis, then that is well. If she does not abandon it, for the sake of making her abandon it she is to be duly instructed and duly admonished up to a second and third time. If, when duly instructed and duly admonished up to a second and third time, she abandons that basis, then that is well. If she does not abandon it, that nun has also incurred a defeat and is not to remain.

Noble ones, I have now recited the eight factors that constitute defeat.

If a nun commits any one of those transgressions, she incurs a defeat just as she did the first time, and in the same way thereafter; she is not permitted to remain in common dwelling or enjoyment with the community of nuns.

In regard to this I ask you, noble ones: Are you pure in this? I ask a second and third time: Are you pure in this? Since the noble ones are pure in this matter and remain silent, I take it that it is so held.

Summary verse:

The first is lewd conduct; the second, groundless accusation;

The third, the taking of a partial side;

The fourth, acting in whatever way one pleases;

The fifth, absence of attachment —

Traveling at night and by day on the road,

And crossing to the far bank of a river, with consent.

Noble ones, these twenty rules of communal uplift for nuns arise from the fortnightly recitation of the sūtra of individual liberation.

Furthermore, whatever nun addresses a woman with words suited to a man, or addresses a man with words suited to a woman, speaking as if she were his wife or his dear companion — even if it is a chance encounter — this matter constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, being angry and filled with aversion, thinking by any means whatsoever to sever this one from the celibate life, brings a baseless charge of defeat against a nun who is pure and without transgression — whether she is asked about it at that time or on some other occasion —

even when not asked, and that dispute too is baseless, and the nun speaks while abiding in aversion and out of aversion — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, being angry and filled with aversion, thinking by any means whatsoever to sever this one from the celibate life, slanders a pure nun without transgression by means of a charge corresponding to what is not that one's own part — a charge that would result in defeat — and whether on that occasion or at another time she is asked about it or not asked about it, that dispute too, one corresponding to what is not her own part, is undertaken through mere whim, by mere intention, and the nun speaks while abiding in aversion and out of aversion — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, becoming attached, accepts something, whatever it may be, from a man who has also become attached — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun says to another nun words such as these: "Noble sister, if you were not yourself attached, then being without attachment you might accept something, whatever it may be, from a man who has become attached" — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, being alone, departs from the rains retreat dwelling at night — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Whatever nun, being alone, departs from the rains retreat dwelling during the day — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, being alone, sets out and travels on the road — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, being alone, crosses to the far bank of a river — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun knowingly does not ordain a woman who has been fully released by a consenting group and approved by the king — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Summary verse:

Taking the belongings of the dead,
granting forbearance to a nun,
abandoning, quarreling,
leaning upon and causing others to lean upon,
splitting the Saṅgha and siding with those who do,
disparaging, giving counsel, and causing distress —

Furthermore, whatever nun follows after and clings to the belongings of the dead — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, knowing that the act of suspension has been carried out against a nun by a harmonious assembly of nuns acting in accordance with the Dharma, leads her beyond the boundary and causes her to seek forbearance — this matter also constitutes from the first instance a transgression with remnant, requiring communal uplift.

Furthermore, whatever nun, enraged, agitated, and indignant, being displeased, speaks thus: "I abandon the Buddha, I abandon the Dharma, I abandon the Saṅgha. Among the renunciants who are sons of the Śākyan, only those who possess ethical conduct, who possess good qualities, who are skilled, who have virtuous Dharma — it is not so; there are other renunciants and brahmins who possess ethical conduct, who possess good qualities, who are skilled, who have virtuous Dharma, and from among those I shall practice

the celibate life" — if she speaks thus, then the nuns should say to her: "Noble sister, you, enraged, agitated, and indignant, being displeased, are saying: 'I abandon the Buddha, I abandon the Dharma, I abandon the Saṅgha. Among the renunciants who are sons of the Śākyan, only those who possess ethical conduct, who possess good qualities, who are skilled, who have virtuous Dharma — it is not so;

there are other renunciants and brahmins who possess ethical conduct, who possess good qualities, who are skilled, who have virtuous Dharma, and from among those I shall practice the celibate life" — she should not say this. The nuns should instruct her thus: "Noble sister, abandon this kind of view, which is a sinful view." When the nuns have so instructed that nun, if she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, in order to have her abandon that ground matter she should be correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time. If, having been correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time, she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, this rule incurs a transgression at the third repetition, one that is to be confessed and entails a meeting of the remaining Saṅgha.

Furthermore, whatever nun engages in wrangling, the nuns should instruct her thus: "Noble sister, do not wrangle. Let go of hostility. Do not dispute. Do not quarrel." When they have so instructed her and she is stopped, if she should say, "There are certain nuns here who go by desire, who go by aversion, who go by delusion, who go by fear — and of nuns who wrangle in this way, some are expelled and some are not expelled," then the nuns should say to that nun: "Noble sister, do not say that the nuns told you not to wrangle, not to drag up faults, not to dispute, not to quarrel — that having been so stopped you said: 'There are certain nuns here who go by desire, who go by aversion, who go by delusion, who go by fear, and of nuns who wrangle in this way, some are expelled and some are not expelled.' Noble sister, abandon this kind of language of going by desire, going by aversion, going by delusion, and going by fear." When the nuns have so instructed that nun, if she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, in order to have her abandon that ground matter she should be correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time. If, having been correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time, she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, this rule also incurs a transgression at the third repetition, one that is to be confessed and

entails a meeting of the remaining Saṅgha.

Furthermore, whatever nun associates with laypeople and, through that association, causes siding with factions, frivolous distraction, and coarse, disruptive conduct, the nuns should instruct her thus: "Noble sister, do not associate with laypeople. Do not, through associating with them, engage in siding with factions, frivolous distraction, and coarse, disruptive conduct. Noble sister, live apart. Know that when you live apart the wholesome qualities will increase, not decline." When the nuns have so instructed that nun, if she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, in order to have her abandon that ground matter she should be correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time. If, having been correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time, she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, this rule also incurs a transgression at the third repetition, one that is to be confessed and entails a meeting of the remaining Saṅgha.

Furthermore, whatever nun, having been instructed by a harmonious assembly of nuns to dwell apart from those particular nuns who live together in a group, abandons that instruction and, knowing full well that those two dwell apart, goes to join that very same side and says: "Sisters, do not the two of you dwell apart. When the two of you dwell apart, you should know that virtuous qualities will only decline and not increase. The two of you should dwell together in a group. When the two of you dwell together in a group, you should know that virtuous qualities will only increase and not decline" — if such a nun speaks in this way, the nuns should instruct her thus: "Sister, you are aware of those nuns who, dwelling together in a group, engage in taking sides, in distraction and confusion, and in harsh and disruptive conduct, and yet knowing full well that those two dwell apart, you say: 'Sisters, do not the two of you dwell apart. When the two of you dwell apart, you should know that virtuous qualities will only decline and not increase. The two of you should dwell together in a group. When the two of you dwell together in a group, you should know that virtuous qualities will only increase and not decline.' Do not say such things. Sister, abandon this view of such a kind, a view that is sinful." The nuns should instruct her in this way. If, having been so instructed by the nuns, she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, in order to have her abandon that ground matter she should be correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time. If, having been correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time, she

abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, this rule also incurs a transgression at the third repetition, one that is to be confessed and entails a meeting of the remaining Saṅgha.

Furthermore, if a nun, having taken up and firmly held a dispute that would weaken the harmony of the Saṅgha and create a schism, persists in it, the nuns should instruct her thus: "Noble one, do not weaken the harmony of the Saṅgha. Do not take up and firmly hold a dispute that would create a schism. Be in harmony with the Saṅgha. Do not break apart what is harmonious; be universally joyful and without quarrel; be of one voice and one proclamation; become like water and milk blended into one; and, illuminating the Teacher's teaching, dwell in ease. Noble one, abandon this ground matter of such a kind, a kind that divides the Saṅgha." The nuns should instruct her in this way. If, having been so instructed by the nuns, she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, in order to have her abandon that ground matter she should be correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time. If, having been correctly instructed and correctly admonished a second and a third time, she abandons that ground matter, that is good. If she does not abandon it, this rule also incurs a transgression at the third repetition, one that is to be confessed and entails a meeting of the remaining Saṅgha.

If there are one, two, or many nuns who are companions of that nun, who side with her dissenting speech, and if they say to the nuns: "Noble ones, whether for good or ill, do not say anything against this nun. Why is that? Noble ones, this nun speaks the Dharma; this nun speaks the Vinaya; this nun has taken up and firmly holds what is in accordance with Dharma and Vinaya and applies it as her standard; this nun speaks with awareness and not out of ignorance. Whatever she approves and accepts, that we too approve and accept" — if they speak in this way, the nuns should address those nuns thus: "Noble ones, whether for good or ill, do not say anything against this nun."

Why is that? Noble ones, this nun speaks what is contrary to Dharma; this nun speaks what is contrary to Vinaya; this nun has taken up and firmly holds what is contrary to Dharma and Vinaya and applies it as her standard; this nun speaks out of ignorance and not with awareness. Whatever she approves and accepts, noble ones, do not accept that.

Noble ones, do not wish to divide the Saṅgha. Noble ones, wish rather for the unity of the Saṅgha. Noble ones, bring the Saṅgha into harmony. Do not split

the harmonious Saṅgha. Be of one joy, without quarrelling, reciting together with one voice, blended like water and milk. If you illuminate the Teacher's teaching in this way, you will dwell in the touch of happiness. Noble ones, you should be instructed to abandon this conduct of taking sides and speaking in discord, which tends toward the splitting of the Saṅgha.

When the nuns are thus instructed by the other nuns, if they relinquish that ground, so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, they should be admonished and instructed a second and a third time for the sake of relinquishing that ground. If, when properly admonished and properly instructed a second and a third time, they relinquish that ground, so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, this matter itself gives rise to a transgression at the second or third time, together with what follows — and that is a Saṅgha remainder.

Now suppose a great many nuns are residing in dependence on a certain town or village, and they are engaging in wicked conduct that brings disgrace upon households — if it is seen, heard, or clearly known that they are bringing disgrace upon households, if it is seen, heard, or clearly known that they are engaging in that wickedness, then the nuns should address those nuns thus: "Noble ones, you are engaging in wicked conduct that brings disgrace upon households. It is seen, heard, and clearly known that you bring disgrace upon households. It is also seen, heard, and clearly known that you engage in wickedness. Noble ones, it is enough for you to remain here; depart from this dwelling from this day forward." You should give them this instruction.

If those nuns then say to the nuns: "Noble ones, there are some nuns here who act out of desire, some who act out of aversion, some who act out of delusion, some who act out of fear — for the very same transgression, some nuns are expelled and some are not expelled" — if they speak in this way, the nuns should address those nuns thus: "Do not say, noble ones, 'There are nuns here who act out of desire, who act out of aversion, who act out of delusion, who act out of fear, and for the very same transgression some nuns are expelled and some are not expelled.' Why is that? It is not that those nuns act out of desire, or act out of aversion, or act out of delusion, or act out of fear. Rather, noble ones, you yourselves are those who engage in wicked conduct that brings disgrace upon households. It is seen, heard, and clearly known that you bring disgrace upon households.

You are also seen, heard, and clearly known to engage in wicked conduct. Therefore, noble ones, you should be admonished to give up such verbal paths as these: 'acting out of desire,' 'acting out of aversion,' 'acting out of delusion,' and 'acting out of fear.'

When the nuns have admonished those nuns in this way, if they relinquish that ground, so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, they should be admonished a second time and a third time, completely and correctly, for the sake of inducing them to relinquish that ground. If, when admonished a second and third time completely and correctly, they relinquish that ground, so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, this matter too becomes a transgression requiring the procedure up to three times, together with a formal act — it is a matter for the remainder of the Saṅgha.

Now, suppose a certain nun here is of a nature that makes her difficult to admonish. When the nuns speak to her in conformity with the Dharma and in conformity with the Vinaya, in accordance with the rules of training pertaining to the recitation and the sūtras of the Sugata (the Well-Gone One), she says: "Noble ones, whether your words are virtuous or non-virtuous, say nothing at all to me. And I too, whether my conduct be virtuous or non-virtuous, will say nothing to the noble ones. Noble ones, abandon this verbal path of admonishing me. What is the use of anything you say to me?" If she thus renders herself one who is not to be spoken to, the nuns should address that nun in this way: "Noble one, do not make yourself one who is not to be spoken to when the nuns speak in conformity with the Dharma and in conformity with the Vinaya, in accordance with the rules of training pertaining to the recitation and the sūtras of the Sugata. Rather, noble one, make yourself one who is to be spoken to alone. When the nuns speak to the noble one in conformity with the Dharma and in conformity with the Vinaya, the noble one too should speak to the nuns in conformity with the Dharma and in conformity with the Vinaya. For it is by this means — by mutually speaking to one another, by mutually instructing and guiding one another, by mutually drawing one another out from transgressions — that the assembly of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, will grow. Noble one, abandon this kind of conduct of making yourself one who is not to be spoken to."

When the nuns have admonished that nun in this way, if she relinquishes that ground, so much the better. If she does not relinquish it, she should be admonished a second time and a third time, completely and correctly, for the

sake of inducing her to relinquish that ground. If, when admonished a second and third time completely and correctly, she relinquishes that ground, so much the better. If she does not relinquish it, this matter too becomes a transgression requiring the procedure up to three times, together with a formal act — it is a matter for the remainder of the Saṅgha.

Noble ones, I have now set forth the twenty rules that are matters for the remainder of the Saṅgha. Of these, twelve are transgressions from the very first offense. Eight are so by the procedure up to three times.

Should a nun commit any one of these transgressions and knowingly conceal it for as long as she does so, she must undergo the penalty of unwished-for removal for the same length of time. Having undergone the unwished-for removal, she must thereafter observe the probationary conduct of satisfying both Saṅghas for half a month. Having observed that conduct of satisfaction, and having made the formal act conform to the Dharma in preparation for rehabilitation and satisfied both assemblies, she is then to be rehabilitated in a place where the combined assembly of both Saṅghas numbers at least forty.

If an assembly that is short by even one of the forty members of the combined Saṅgha performs the rehabilitation of that nun, the rehabilitation does not take effect, and those assembled Saṅghas are themselves to be censured. That is the procedure for this matter.

In this regard, I am to ask the noble ones: "Are you pure in this?" I am to ask "Are you pure in this?" a second and a third time. When the noble ones are pure in this, they indicate it by remaining silent, and it is thus understood.

Summary verse:

Keeping, parting with, setting aside,
Washing, receiving,
Soliciting, upper robe and lower robe combined —
These are each subject to forfeiture.

Noble ones, these thirty-three rules entailing forfeiture are recited every half-month as they arise from the individual liberation sūtra (Skt. prātimokṣasūtra).

A nun who has obtained a robe and pulled out the lining threads is to keep any surplus robe for up to ten days without making it allowable. If she keeps it beyond that, it is a transgression entailing forfeiture. A nun who has obtained a robe and pulled out the lining threads — if even for a single night she

separates herself from any one of the five robes beyond the boundary, except with the Saṅgha's permission, it is a transgression entailing forfeiture. A nun who has obtained a robe and pulled out the lining threads, and who then finds herself wanting an out-of-season robe, may accept that robe. Having accepted it, if she rises promptly, she is to have it made into a robe immediately and keep it. If she does not rise promptly and there is a prospect of supplementing the robe with what has not yet been supplemented, she is to set that robe aside until the end of one month. If she keeps it beyond that, it is a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun washes, scrubs, or beats an old robe belonging to a monk who is not a relative commits a transgression entailing forfeiture. Whatever nun accepts a robe from a monk who is not a relative — except in exchange — commits a transgression entailing forfeiture. Whatever nun goes to the home of a householder or a householder's wife who is not a relative and solicits a robe, except at an appropriate time, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture. The appropriate time is this: if a nun's robe has been stolen, lost, burned, carried off by the wind, or carried away by water — that is the appropriate time. If a nun's robe has been stolen, lost, burned, carried off by the wind, or carried away by water, she may go to the home of a householder or a householder's wife who is not a relative and solicit a robe. If on that occasion a faithful brahmin or householder wishes to offer many robes, that nun may accept from him at most a complete set consisting of an upper robe and a lower robe. If she accepts more than that, it is a transgression entailing forfeiture.

If a householder or a householder's wife who is not a relative has set aside funds for a robe on behalf of a nun, with the thought: "Having set aside these funds for a robe, I shall purchase with these funds such-and-such a robe and, when the nun by the name of such-and-such arrives, I shall at the proper time present her with a suitable robe" — and if, before she has been informed of this, that nun forms some intention and, out of desire for something better, goes to the home of a householder or a householder's wife who is not a relative and says: "Venerable sir, please use the funds set aside as the price of my robe to purchase such-and-such a robe for me, and present me with a suitable robe at the proper time" — and if the robe is duly produced, it is a transgression entailing forfeiture.

If a householder or a householder's wife who is not a relative has each separately set aside funds for a robe on behalf of a nun, with the thought: "We

two have each separately set aside these separate funds for robes; we shall purchase such-and-such separate robes with these separate robe-funds, and when the nun by the name of such-and-such arrives, we two shall each separately and at the proper time present her with a suitable robe" —

Now, in that situation, if before she has been approached, some thought arises in that nun — out of desire for something fine — and she goes to the householder or the householder's wife who is not a relative and says: "How good it is, venerable ones, that you have set aside separate robe-funds on my behalf! With those separate robe-funds, please each purchase such-and-such separate robes, then pool them together and present me with a suitable robe at the proper time" — and if the robe is duly produced, it is a transgression entailing forfeiture.

If robe-funds have been sent by a king, or a great minister, or a brahmin, or a householder, or a village man, or a country man, or a man of wealth, or a merchant, or a caravan leader, in the hand of a messenger on behalf of a nun, and that messenger takes those robe-funds and goes to where that nun is and says to her: "Noble one, please be aware: a king, or a great minister, or a brahmin, or a householder, or a village man, or a country man, or a man of wealth, or a merchant, or a caravan leader — or the mistress of a caravan leader — has sent these robe-funds for you. Noble one, out of compassion please accept them" — then that nun should say to the messenger: "Venerable messenger, it is not fitting for nuns to accept robe-funds. When we find a suitable robe at the proper time, we will accept it."

If that messenger then says to the nun: "Noble one, is there any steward who serves the noble ones, any steward who acts on behalf of the noble ones?" — then that nun, wishing for a robe, should point out to the messenger either the monastery steward or a lay steward, saying: "That person is a steward who serves the nuns; that one acts on behalf of the nuns."

Then that messenger should take the robe-funds and go to where that steward is, and on arriving should say to the steward: "Venerable steward, please know this: with these robe-funds, purchase such-and-such a robe, and when the nun by the name of such-and-such arrives, present her with a suitable robe at the proper time."

Then that messenger, having thoroughly and correctly instructed and indicated this to the steward, should go to where that nun is, and on arriving should say to the nun: "Noble one, the steward you pointed out to me — I have

correctly indicated the matter to him. Please go to him, and he will present you with a suitable robe at the proper time."

That nun, wishing for a robe, should go to the steward and remind him, saying two or three times: "Venerable steward, I need a robe. Venerable steward, I need a robe." She should prompt and remind him two or three times. If the robe is then produced, that is excellent. If it is not produced, she should remain silent — neither speaking nor pressing the matter in any direction — up to four, five, or six times. If, after remaining silent up to four, five, or six times, the robe is produced, that is excellent. If it is not produced, she may then exert herself to have the robe obtained; and if the robe is thereby obtained, it is a transgression entailing forfeiture. If it is not produced, she should herself go to the place from which those robe-funds came.

Alternatively, through a trustworthy messenger she may send word to those persons, saying: "Venerable ones, you sent robe-funds as an offering for such-and-such a nun; know that nothing has been accomplished for that nun. Venerable ones, please take care that your own wealth is not lost." That is the proper procedure in such a case.

A summary verse:

Gold and silver, trading and commerce,
seeking out and weaving, accumulating,
giving, seizing, dedicating, storing,
keeping and failing to consecrate.

Furthermore, whatever nun receives gold or silver with her own hand, or causes it to be received, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun engages in various forms of trading conduct commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun engages in various forms of buying and selling commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun, while still possessing a serviceable bowl not lacking the five kinds of lacquer repair, seeks another new bowl out of desire for something better, and it is obtained, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture. That nun must then offer that bowl to the assembly of nuns. Whichever bowl in that assembly is the most worn out shall be given to that nun, with these words: "Nun, you must not consecrate this bowl, must not assign it, and must not give it to another; you must use it gradually and gently

until it is worn through and broken." That is the proper procedure in such a case.

Furthermore, whatever nun takes yarn she herself has acquired and has it woven by a weaver who is not a relative, and the cloth is thereby completed, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

If a householder or a householder's wife who is not a relative has a weaver who is not a relative weave cloth on behalf of a nun, and if that nun, without having been asked beforehand, develops some idea about it and goes to the weaver who is not a relative and speaks thus — "Venerable weaver, know this: this cloth is being woven for her sake. Venerable weaver, make this cloth wide in breadth, long in length, tightly woven, and of good quality. Venerable weaver, she will give you remuneration of this kind — food, or lodging, or a little something to eat" — and if that nun, in order to have the cloth completed, then gives such remuneration — food, or lodging, or a little something to eat — and the cloth is thereby completed, she commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun, having given a robe to a nun and thereafter becoming angry, enraged, and irritated, in a state of displeasure snatches it back or causes it to be snatched back, and says, "I am not giving you this robe; return it" — if a surplus remains with that nun, she must return it, and if she assigns it, she commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun knowingly diverts to an individual gains that have been dedicated to the Saṅgha commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

The Blessed One declared that sick nuns may avail themselves individually of the following medicines: clarified butter, oil of grain, molasses, honey, and the froth of molasses. Should a sick nun desire any of these, she may herself consecrate them, store them for up to seven days, and use them fully by consuming them entirely. If she consumes them beyond that period, she commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

A nun may keep a surplus bowl for up to one day. If she keeps it beyond that, she commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun fails to consecrate a robe that is fit for consecration on the first day of the first half of the month commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

A summary verse:

Taking out and not taking out, begging,
robes and robe-materials, bedding materials,
rains-lodging materials, persons,
the Saṅgha — binding and loosing, heavy and light.

Furthermore, whatever nun spreads out her bed-mat at an improper time commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun fails to spread out her bed-mat at the proper time commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun begs with a show of trading conduct for her own sake commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun converts into food, for the purpose of eating, gains received on behalf of another, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun converts into food, for the purpose of eating, any gains whatsoever received for the purpose of robes, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun converts into food, for the purpose of eating, any gains whatsoever received for the purpose of bedding materials, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun converts into food, for the purpose of eating, any gains whatsoever received for the purpose of a rains-lodging, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun diverts to an individual gains that were pledged on behalf of a large number of nuns, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun diverts to herself gains that were pledged on behalf of the nuns' Saṅgha, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun out of attachment has bundles tied and untied repeatedly, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun carries a robe that is heavy in weight and heavy in value, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever nun carries one that is light in weight but heavy in value, commits a transgression entailing forfeiture.

A summary verse:

Wool alone, two parts,
six, a span, the road,
washing and carrying, horse, and hermitage —
all the rest, save the great cloth.

Noble ones, I have now set forth the thirty-three rules entailing forfeiture. Concerning these, I ask you noble ones: are you completely pure in this regard? A second and a third time I ask: are you completely pure in this regard? If the noble ones are completely pure, they remain silent, and so it shall be understood.

The Prātimokṣa Sūtra of the Nuns — the second and final section.

A general summary verse:

Falsehood, seeds, sitting and dwelling,
the comfort of living creatures, animals,
theft and food —
these are considered to be held in common.

A summary verse:

Lying, censuring a monk, backbiting,
causing distress, teaching,
recitation, wrongful conduct, and Dharma,
acting for a friend's sake, and belittling.

Noble ones, these one hundred and eighty rules entailing transgression arise from the recitation of the Prātimokṣa Sūtra twice a month.

Knowingly speaking a falsehood commits a transgression. Speaking in terms of a person's faults commits a transgression. Committing backbiting against a nun commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun, knowing that a dispute has been lawfully settled by the unanimous Saṅgha in accordance with the Dharma, deliberately stirs up that affair again, commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun teaches the Dharma to a man in more than five or six words — except to a woman of discernment — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun recites Dharma by way of words with a person who has not received full ordination commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun discloses a transgression involving wrongful conduct to a person who has not received full ordination, except with the

permission of the Saṅgha, commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun truthfully declares to a person who has not received full ordination a superhuman quality commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun, having first arranged things well, subsequently says, "Noble ones, what was dedicated to the Saṅgha's gains out of regard for a friend — that I have dedicated to my own person," commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun, when reciting the Prātimokṣa Sūtra twice a month, says, "Noble ones, what purpose is served by those who cause nuns regret, distress of mind, and harm by means of these minutely detailed, extremely subtle training rules, in reciting the Prātimokṣa Sūtra twice a month?" — and thereby belittles the training — commits a transgression.

A summary verse:

Seeds, belittling, instructing,
the chair, the stuffing, and pressing down with the foot,
the source-beings, and the sprinkling —
these are enumerated in two stages.

To destroy or cause the destruction of a cluster of seeds or the dwelling of source-beings commits a transgression. To belittle or mock from the side commits a transgression. To wear the instructing ornament on the ear commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun spreads or has spread on the ground a chair, a small chair, a mat with inner stuffing, a cushion, a pad, or a round cushion lacking a cover belonging to the Saṅgha, and then departs without gathering it up, without having it gathered up, and without entrusting it to a nun who is present — except in circumstances of that kind — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun spreads or has spread on the ground a grass stuffing or a leaf stuffing in the Saṅgha's rains-retreat hall, and then departs without gathering it up, without having it gathered up, and without entrusting it to a nun who is present — except in circumstances of that kind — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun arrives late at the Saṅgha's rains-retreat hall, knowing that another nun was there first, and then, using as a pretext that whoever disturbs her will have to leave, presses that nun out and lies or sits on the mat — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun, knowing that a chair or small chair placed in the open air above the Saṅgha's rains-retreat hall will cause damage at its base, nonetheless sets it down heavily and sits or lies upon it — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun knowingly sprinkles or has sprinkled grass, mud, or earth with water containing living beings — commits a transgression.

If a nun is to build or have built a large dwelling, she should survey the site with the understanding of how much space the doorway, the extension, and the visible area will require, and then build it two or at most three courses of brick high. To build beyond that commits a transgression.

A summary verse:

One lodging place, flour, the accepting of food, the pressing down,
the assembly, the wrong time,
the storing away, and swallowing from the mouth.

Whatever nun is in a single lodging place and is a nun of standing seniority who is not ill — she should eat a single almsfood meal. To eat beyond that commits a transgression.

When a number of nuns have gone to households and, while they are there, faithful brahmins or householders insistently offer them flour and provisions in due season, those nuns may accept two or three bowlfuls. To accept beyond that commits a transgression. Having accepted two or three bowlfuls, they should go to the outer pleasure grove, divide the share among the nuns who are present, and all should eat together. That is the proper procedure.

Furthermore, whatever nun, having already eaten and without making what remains into surplus, accepts further food or eats it — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun knowingly seeks an occasion against another nun who has already eaten and has made no surplus, with the thought, "By any means I will cause this nun to incur an offense," and on that very pretext urges her, "Noble one, eat this, eat this," and thereby offers her food that has not been made into surplus at the proper moment — commits a transgression.

To eat in a group assembly is a transgression except at the proper times. The proper times are these: the time of illness, the time of work, the time of travel, the time of embarking on a boat, a great gathering, and the mealtime of the ascetic's food — those are the proper times.

Furthermore, whatever nun accepts food or eats at a time that is not the proper time — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun eats or accepts accepted food or provisions that have been stored away — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun eats food swallowed from the mouth without having received it properly — except for water and tooth-wood — commits a transgression.

A summary verse:

With living beings, and naked...

Viewing troops, two nights, an arranged battle formation and striking, threatening, and taking an inferior lodging.

Furthermore, whatever nun knowingly uses water containing living beings — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun gives food or provisions from her own hand to a naked woman, or to a male wanderer or a female wanderer — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun goes to watch an army that has set out for battle — commits a transgression. If there is some reason that causes a nun who has gone to watch an army setting out for battle to remain, that nun may stay within the army camp for up to two nights. If she stays longer than that, she commits a transgression. Even while a nun is staying within the army camp for those two nights, if she goes to watch an arranged battle formation, or a gathering of victory banners, or an assembly of troops, or an arrayed army engaged in combat — she commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun, inflamed with rage and discontent, strikes a fellow nun — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun, inflamed with rage and discontent, raises her hand threateningly against a fellow nun — even so much as with an open palm — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun knowingly conceals a transgression involving a grave offence on the part of a fellow nun — commits a transgression.

A summary verse:

Comfort and fire, and intention,
one not fully ordained, and Dharma teaching,
a novice, changing one's appearance,
precious things, and the hot season.

Furthermore, whatever nun seeks out a fault, intending by all means to find a fault in a fellow nun, and with that very intention says to a nun, "Noble one, come here, go to those households; there they will be made to give you as much food and provisions as you wish" — and then, without having caused anything to be given, says furthermore: "Noble one, it is not comfortable to speak or to sit together with her there; rather, if she speaks or sits alone, it is more comfortable — so you go" — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun touches fire, or causes fire to be touched, for her own sake at an improper time — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun, having submitted a motion regarding a Dharma-concordant act of the Saṅgha, subsequently in anger and discontent acts to obstruct it and says, "Take back the motion. I will not give you this" — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun sleeps in the same lodging for more than two nights together with a person who has not received full ordination — commits a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever nun says: "Those things that the Blessed One has taught as obstructing factors — even when one makes use of them, they do not constitute an obstruction. That is how I understand the Dharma taught by the Blessed One" — the nuns must address that nun as follows: "Noble ones, do not say, 'Those things that the Blessed One has taught as obstructing factors — even when one makes use of them, they do not constitute an obstruction; that is how I understand the Dharma taught by the Blessed One.' Do not slander the Blessed One. Slandering the Blessed One does not lead to good. The Blessed One would not say such a thing. Noble one, the obstructing factors are indeed obstructions — so the Blessed One has declared in many ways. If one makes use of them, one will be obstructed. Noble one, abandon this evil view of such a kind." The nuns must thus admonish her. If she relinquishes that position, well and good. If she does not relinquish it, in order to bring her to relinquish that position, the admonition must be given a second and a third time correctly; she must be instructed correctly.

If upon being admonished a second and a third time correctly, and instructed correctly, she relinquishes that position, well and good. If she does not relinquish it, she incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a nun, knowingly, associates with a person who speaks in such a way and who has not abandoned those aspects of a wrong and sinful view contrary to the Dharma — conversing with her, going about with her, residing together with her, enjoying things together with her, or sleeping in the same dwelling as her — she incurs a transgression.

If a novice nun says the following: "Those things which the Blessed One has declared to be obstructing factors are indeed obstructing factors — yet though one makes use of them, one will not be obstructed. This is how I understand the Dharma as taught by the Blessed One," then the nuns must address that novice nun thus: "Novice nun, do not say that the Blessed One has declared these things to be obstructing factors yet that, though one makes use of them, one will not be obstructed — do not say that this is how you understand the Dharma as taught by the Blessed One. Do not slander the Blessed One. Slandering the Blessed One does not lead to good. The Blessed One would not say such a thing. Novice nun, the Blessed One has declared in many ways that obstructing factors are indeed obstructions, and that if one makes use of them one will be obstructed. Therefore, novice nun, abandon this evil view of such a kind." The nuns must thus admonish her. If upon being admonished in this way she relinquishes that position, well and good. If she does not relinquish it, in order to bring her to relinquish that position, the admonition must be given a second and a third time correctly; she must be instructed correctly. If upon being admonished a second and a third time correctly, and instructed correctly, she relinquishes that position, well and good. If she does not relinquish it, the nuns must address that novice nun thus: "Novice nun, from this day forward you may not say that the Blessed One — the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha — is your Teacher. You may not follow after any person of pure conduct who is learned and like a spiritual guide. The permission you have had to sleep in the same dwelling together with nuns and novice nuns up to two nights in a row is henceforth withdrawn from you. O deluded woman, you are expelled — go elsewhere." The nuns must thus admonish her.

Furthermore, if a nun, knowingly, receives a novice nun who has been so expelled — hosting her, serving her, sharing things with her, residing together with her, or sleeping in the same dwelling as her — she incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a nun obtains new cloth, she must have it altered in three ways as regards its color, dyeing it with blue, or red, or ochre, or some such color. If a nun makes use of new cloth that has not been so altered in three ways by dyeing it with blue, or red, or ochre, or some such color, and she uses and wears it, she incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a nun receives with her own hand — or causes another to receive — a precious jewel or something spoken of as precious jewel, except when she is sitting within the confines of a monastery or within a dwelling, she incurs a transgression. If a nun is sitting within the monastery grounds and there is a precious jewel present, and she picks it up thinking, "Whose is this? Someone will surely come to take it" — with such a mind she may take it up, and that is the proper procedure.

The Blessed One has declared that bathing is to be done every half-month. If one does so at a time outside that appointed time, it is not the proper time, and she incurs a transgression. The proper times are as follows: the last half-month, plus two, of the months of summer —

the first part of summer, and these three half-months together constitute the season of heat. The remaining permitted times are as follows: the season of illness, the season of work, the season of travel, the season of wind, the season of rain, and the season of drizzle — these are the proper times.

In summary:

Animals, remorse, the finger,
playing in water, together startling,
concealing, and groundless accusation,
and traveling without a female companion.

If any nun intentionally kills a living creature belonging to the animal realm, she incurs a transgression. If any nun, acting with deliberate intent and motivated by the thought "I will arrange it so that this nun does not for even a single moment come into contact with comfort," provokes remorse in that nun, she incurs a transgression. If she causes tickling with a finger, she incurs a transgression. If she plays in water, she incurs a transgression. If any nun sleeps in the same dwelling together with a man, she incurs a transgression. If any nun startles a nun, or causes another to startle her, even if it was merely intended as a joke, she incurs a transgression. If any nun conceals, or causes to be concealed, the alms bowl, the Dharma robe, the straining cloth, the

small bowl, the belt, or any other requisite of a nun's livelihood belonging to a nun, a probationer, or a novice nun — unless there is a corresponding circumstance — she incurs a transgression. If any nun, out of anger and aversion, levies against a blameless nun free of transgressions a baseless charge of a saṃghāvaśeṣa offense, she incurs a transgression. If any nun travels on a road together with a man without a female companion, even if only as far as a village, she incurs a transgression.

In summary:

Theft, and digging the earth,
accepting invitations, and the training,
quarreling, staying silent, going,
being disrespectful, drinking alcohol, and at an improper time.

If any nun travels together with a thief who shares the same destination, even if only as far as a village, she incurs a transgression. If any nun digs the earth herself with her own hand, or causes it to be dug, she incurs a transgression. A nun may accept invitations for four months; if she accepts beyond that, she incurs a transgression. Exceptions are: a specific invitation, a repeated invitation, a timely invitation, and a standing invitation — these are proper times. If any nun, when instructed by the nuns, "Noble one, you should train in this training," responds with words such as, "I am a child, ignorant, unclear, and unskilled; I shall not train in this training until I have consulted those nuns who hold the sūtras, those who hold the Vinaya, and those who hold the mātṛkā," she incurs a transgression. A nun who wishes to know everything fully should train in that training. She should indeed inquire of those nuns who hold the sūtras, those who hold the Vinaya, and those who hold the mātṛkā — that is the proper procedure. If any nun, while in the midst of quarreling with other nuns, reviling them, being at odds with them, and engaging in dispute, thinks, "I will listen to whatever these nuns say, and on that basis assign designations accordingly," and sits listening in silence — that circumstance excepted — she incurs a transgression. If any nun, when the Saṅgha is settling a matter in accordance with Dharma, rises from her seat and departs without speaking — unless she is a nun present there who is unable to speak due to a corresponding circumstance — she incurs a transgression. If she acts without respect, she incurs a transgression. If she drinks grain alcohol or prepared alcohol that can cause intoxication, she incurs a transgression. If any nun goes to a village at an improper time without speaking to the nuns who are present — unless there is a corresponding circumstance — she incurs a transgression.

In summary:

Food present, at the very break of dawn —

needle cases, bed legs, spreading mats, cushions, covering cloths, and the Sugata's measure for Dharma robes.

Furthermore, any nun who has been invited as a guest to a household with food and then wanders through households in the morning and afternoon without informing the householders who are present there — unless there is a corresponding circumstance — incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any nun who, before dawn, before the break of day, passes beyond the firmly closed gate or the vicinity of the firmly closed gate of a king consecrated by royal anointing upon the crown of his head, without having gathered jewels or things designated as jewels — unless there is a corresponding circumstance — incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, when a nun recites the sūtra of individual liberation at each half-monthly recitation and says, "Noble ones, this rule too is included in the sūtra, is gathered within the sūtra — I have only now come to know this" — and if the other nuns know that this nun has been present at the restoration ceremony two or three times, let alone many times — then since that nun cannot be released through ignorance, she is to be made to act in accordance with Dharma with respect to whatever transgression has arisen. Beyond that, she is to be rebuked as follows: "You, nun, when the sūtra of individual liberation is being recited at each half-monthly recitation, do not listen to the Dharma with respect, do not regard it as a teacher, do not regard it as a guiding post, do not take it to heart, do not focus the mind upon it with one-pointedness, do not lend your ear, do not listen to the Dharma with the whole mind in contemplation. You have gained what is not a gain and have not gained what is a gain; you have found a fault and have not found what is good." She is to be made to feel remorse. The making of her feel remorse in this regard is itself a transgression.

Furthermore, any nun who has a needle case made from bone, horn, or tusk, retaining it, incurs a transgression.

If a nun has a seat or small seat made for the Saṅgha, she may have it made to the measure of the Sugata — eight of the Sugata's finger-widths — excepting what goes into the hollow at the base. If she has it made larger than that, upon being cut down, she incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a nun places wood or a wooden fleece spread as a spreading layer on a seat or small seat of the Saṅgha, upon being removed, she incurs a transgression.

If a nun has a cushion made, she may have it made according to the prescribed measure. The measure for a cushion is this: as high as the Sugata's height in height, half the Sugata's height in width, and one full Sugata's height is to be used for the padding. If she has it made larger than that, upon being cut down, she incurs a transgression.

If a nun has a covering cloth made, she may have it made according to the prescribed measure. The measure for a covering cloth is this: four of the Sugata's heights in height, one of the Sugata's heights in width. If she has it made larger than that, upon being cut down, she incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any nun who has a Dharma robe made to the Sugata's prescribed measure for Dharma robes, or who has one made larger than the Sugata's prescribed Dharma robe measure, incurs a transgression. The measure of the Sugata's Dharma robe is this: ten of the Sugata's heights in height, six of the Sugata's heights in width. This, then, is the measure of the Sugata's Dharma robe.

The seventy-two rules set out in this way are held to be shared in common with monks. The one hundred and eight rules specific to nuns are those that follow below.

In summary:

Not yet twelve, drawing out, tending the sick,
listening, sitting alone on a chair,
sandals, green onion, Dharma, and
the assembly, and not going — these are the last.

Summary verse:

Not yet twelve, a retinue and many retinues,
twelve and twenty, households thirty-two,
the untrained and the trained,
selling Dharma — a group is gathered here.

Furthermore, any nun who, having herself received full ordination, gives the going-forth to another or confers full ordination before twelve years have passed, incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any nun who installs a retinue without the Saṅgha's permission incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who installs a large retinue without the Saṅgha's permission incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowingly, confers full ordination on a married woman before twelve years have passed incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowingly, confers full ordination on an unmarried woman before twenty years have passed incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who confers full ordination on a married woman who has reached twelve years of age but has not been given the vow of training in the six rules and the six corresponding rules for two years incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who confers full ordination on an unmarried woman who has reached twenty years of age but has not been given the vow of training in the six rules and the six corresponding rules for two years incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who confers full ordination on a woman who has not trained for two years in the six rules and the six corresponding rules incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, having trained for two years in the six rules and the six corresponding rules, does not confer full ordination incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, to a woman desiring full ordination, says something to this effect — "If she gives you a robe, then for that reason you shall receive full ordination" — incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

Leading away, year by year without permission,
confused, pregnant, grief-stricken, shackled,
not conferring benefit, not drawing out,
and not training in the precepts.

Furthermore, any nun who says to a laywoman, "Leave your household life; going forth later will not be difficult," and then does not give her the going-forth incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who gives the going-forth year after year incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowingly, gives the going-forth to a woman whose guardian has not given permission incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowingly, gives the going-forth to a confused woman incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowingly, gives the going-forth to a pregnant woman incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowingly, gives the going-forth to a woman tormented by grief incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowingly, gives the going-forth to a woman who is shackled incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, having given

the going-forth or conferred full ordination, does not confer benefit incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, when she sees an obstacle arising for those to whom she has given the going-forth or conferred full ordination, does not draw them out incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, having given the going-forth or conferred full ordination, does not engage them in training in the precepts incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

Tending the sick, fish sauce, the fingers,
the palms, the hair, two kinds of solitude,
two kinds without a screen above,
and speaking while pouring into the ear.

Furthermore, any nun who does not tend to the sick among those who reside with her and those who are nearby incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who places fish sauce inside something intended for her own use incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who washes beyond two finger-joints inside something intended for her use incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who claps her palms against something intended for her use incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who shaves the hair of the private region incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who sits in solitude in a sheltered place with a layman incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who sits in solitude in a sheltered place with a monk incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who stands in an unsheltered place with a layman incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who stands in an unsheltered place with a monk incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any nun who whispers into a layman's ear and speaks thus incurs a transgression.

Summary verse: Listening and two kinds of monks, two kinds of learning and wound-bandaging, a child and a household and without having inspected, and sleeping alone at night.

Furthermore, any nun who listens to a layman whispering in her ear and speaking incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who whispers into a monk's ear and speaks incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who listens to a monk whispering in her ear and speaking incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who receives a charm from a layman incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who recites a charm from a layman incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who by deceptive means causes

a bound wound to be untied incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who nurses a child incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who sleeps the night in another household without having asked the householder incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who sleeps the night without having inspected whether the lodging is safe incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who sleeps the night in a dwelling without another nun present incurs a transgression.

Summary verse: Sleeping in one bed, rubbing the body in five ways, bathing and washing, fragrant substances, grain-oil, and water-bathing.

Furthermore, any nun who sleeps together with another nun in a single bed incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who has another nun rub her own body incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who has a female probationer rub her own body incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who has a laywoman rub her own body incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who has a female wanderer rub her own body incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who has a woman bathe and wash her own body incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who applies fragrant substances to her own body incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who applies a grain-oil massage to her own body incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who bathes in water with hands joined incurs a transgression.

Summary verse: A crystal comb, tooth-cleaning sticks, three bamboo combs, a hair-piece, ornaments, dancing, singing, playing music, and carrying a parasol.

Furthermore, any nun who combs her hair with a crystal comb incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who combs her hair with a tooth-cleaning stick incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who combs her hair with a bamboo comb incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who combs her hair with all three together — a crystal comb, a tooth-cleaning stick, and a bamboo comb — incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who wears a hairpiece incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who wears the ornaments of a laywoman incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who dances incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who sings incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who touches a musical instrument incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who carries a parasol incurs a transgression.

Summary verse: Shoes, wiping a footstool and pressing it down, a mat and thread from a household, keeping company with the naked, clothing, selling

food, and seeking provisions.

Furthermore, any nun who wears shoes incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who accepts the service of sitting upon a chair incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who without having announced it to another household sits down after wiping and pressing upon a mat incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, after giving a Dharma teaching, departs without having handed back the layman's seat incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who carries a load of thread incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any nun who performs household labor incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who keeps company with the naked incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who appropriates the robes of the community of nuns for herself incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who keeps food incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, having eaten a meal to her fill, then rises from her seat and eats again incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

Garlic, body hair, water cloth,
entry into the rains and the renunciant's robe,
coveting lordship and praise, household
and dwelling and gains.

Furthermore, any nun who eats garlic incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who does not maintain a razor incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who does not maintain a water cloth incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, while washing and bathing, lets her robe slip carelessly incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who gives the renunciant's robe to a layman for the purpose of dividing it incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who sews a Dharma robe onto the chief of a retinue incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who covets praise incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who covets a household incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who covets a dwelling incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who covets gains incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

Dharma and two kinds of expulsion,
gossip, oath-breaking, striking oneself,
contempt and taunting, throwing water,
and leaving disputes to dissolve on their own.

Furthermore, any nun who covets the Dharma incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, having become angry and enraged and being displeased, expels a nun from the rains-retreat dwelling incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, knowing that a nun is already residing in another's household, arrives later and expels her incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, without proper perception, hearing, or suspicion, discusses the transgressions of a nun incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who breaks an oath incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, having become angry and enraged and being displeased, strikes herself incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who shows contempt toward the community of nuns incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who taunts the community of nuns incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who throws water on the chief of a retinue incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, while having the power to do so, leaves a dispute among nuns to dissolve without resolution incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

Aspirations, instruction, the rains retreat,
the invitation ceremony, the restoration ceremony, the ordination ceremony,
the drawing of lots, the robe distribution, the rains dwelling,
and wandering abroad during the rains.

Furthermore, any nun who presents a petition when the time for it has passed incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, seeking guidance every fortnight, does not accept instruction and teaching from a monk incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who agrees to observe the rains retreat at a place where no monks are present incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who, having observed the rains retreat, does not perform the invitation ceremony before both communities of the Saṅgha by means of the three grounds of what has been seen, heard, or suspected incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who performs the restoration ceremony without a monk being present incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who initiates the ordination ceremony for a poor candidate incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who does not assemble the company required to conduct the ceremony of drawing lots for ordination incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who does not assemble the company required for the purpose of gathering for the distribution of robes incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who departs from the rains-retreat dwelling without having entrusted it to another incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any nun who wanders abroad during the rains retreat incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

Not going out of fear, an unfavorable district,
Quarreling, inquiring, going alone,
Urinating on green grass, not looking through a crack —
These constitute the final group.

Furthermore, any nun who, during the rains retreat, does not go to the boundary of an arrow's range below the dwelling incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who wanders and travels through a region that is feared to harbor danger in the surrounding district incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who wanders and travels through a region whose surrounding district is unfavorable incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who quarrels at another's dwelling incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who inquires without first opening the occasion properly incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who goes alone to an outlying place incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who deposits excrement or urine on green grass incurs a transgression. Furthermore, any nun who deposits excrement or urine without having looked through the crack in a wall incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

One hundred and eight rules not shared with monks,
Seventy-two shared with the monks —
Those residing in the one hundred and eighty
Are solely transgressions.

Expulsion, not appointed, sun and its setting,
Food, and the two kinds of Dharma robes,
Shared purpose, the boat, the two solitudes,
Setting to work, repeatedly washing,
The sleeping place, sitting and standing,
Without confidence, not having reached twenty,
The eighteen heavy transgressions —
The remainder that may be used is intended here.

Noble ones, I have now recited these one hundred and eighty rules on transgressions. Concerning them, I ask the noble ones: Are you completely

pure in this? A second time I ask: Are you completely pure in this? A third time I ask: Are you completely pure in this? If the noble ones are completely pure in this, they remain silent; and that silence I take to mean exactly so.

Summary verse:

Milk, curds, butter,
Clarified butter, grain-oil, honey,
Molasses, fish, meat,
And dried meat — the training rules on giving have been set forth.

Noble ones, these eleven rules requiring individual confession arise from the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra (the sūtra of individual liberation), which is recited twice each month.

Furthermore, if a nun who is not ill has taken milk from another's household for her own benefit and drunk it, that nun must go to the outer rains-retreat hall and confess individually before the nuns, saying: "Noble ones, an improper matter worthy of censure has arisen in me — I confess it individually. This rule is one to be confessed individually."

Furthermore, if a nun who is not ill has taken curds, butter, clarified butter, grain-oil, honey, the froth of molasses, fish, meat, or dried meat from another's household for her own benefit and drunk or eaten them, that nun must go to the outer rains-retreat hall and confess individually before the nuns, saying: "Noble ones, an improper matter worthy of censure has arisen in me — I confess it. This rule is one to be confessed individually."

Furthermore, if a nun — without having been invited beforehand as a guest — has gone to a household of trainees that is bound under the training vows of the Saṅgha, and has with her own hand taken food and drink to eat or consume there, that nun must go to the outer rains-retreat hall and confess individually before the nuns, saying: "Noble ones, an improper matter worthy of censure has arisen in me — I confess it. This rule is one to be confessed individually."

Noble ones, I have now recited these eleven rules requiring individual confession. Concerning them, I ask the noble ones: Are you completely pure in this? A second time I ask: Are you completely pure in this? A third time I ask: Are you completely pure in this?

Noble ones, if you are completely pure in this, your silence signifies it. So it is held.

Summary verse:

Eight rules concerning the lower robe, three concerning the upper robe, six beginning with the tightly bound, five beginning with the head covering, five beginning with jumping, five beginning with gathering, eight rules on sitting, and eight rules on receiving.

Noble ones, these many rules of training arise from the fortnightly recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra. One must train to wear the lower robe evenly and squarely. Not too high, not too low, not like an elephant's trunk, not like a palm leaf, not like a grain stalk, not like the spread hood of a snake, and not wearing the lower robe so as to expose the waist — this is the training. One must train to wear the upper robe evenly and squarely. One must train to wear the upper robe so that it is neither too high nor too low. One must train in the following: being well composed, moving in an orderly manner, not letting the eyes wander, walking while looking only as far ahead as the length of a yoke, not going to another's house out of attachment. One must train to go to another's house without covering the head, without tucking up the robe, without pulling it tight, without throwing it back over the neck, and without throwing it back over the shoulder. One must train to go to another's house without jumping, without tossing the robe, not going in a crouching manner, not going with the chest thrust forward, and without leaning to one side. One must train to go to another's house without swaying the body, without swinging the arms, without turning the head, without raising the shoulders, and without clasping the hands together. One must train to sit on a seat in another's house: not sitting before having examined the seat, not sinking down with the full weight of the body, not crossing the feet, not crossing the thighs, not placing one leg on top of the other, not drawing the feet up, not stretching the feet out, and not sitting in a way that reveals what is between the legs. One must train to receive food properly: not receiving it in disconnected pieces or all at once, but evenly and in proportion; looking into the bowl; not receiving food in the bowl before what is to be eaten and drunk has arrived; not covering rice with a curry in order to get more; not covering curry with rice; and not receiving food in the bowl on top of what is already there to be eaten and drunk.

Summary verse:

Six proper actions with regard to food, five beginning with making smacking sounds, five concerning separating out grains, five beginning with licking the fingers, one must train to eat food properly. One must train not to open the

mouth with a morsel that is too small or too large, with a morsel still being formed, or with a morsel that has not been properly gathered, and not to speak with the mouth full of food. One must train not to eat while making smacking sounds, not making clicking sounds, not making "hu hu" sounds, not making "pu pu" sounds, and not sticking out the tongue to eat. One must train to eat food without separating out the grains, without scattering droppings, without moving the morsels around, without breaking off crusts, and without spilling morsels. One must train not to lick the fingers, not to wipe the bowl with the hand, not to shake the hand, not to tilt the bowl, and not to pile food up like a stūpa before eating.

Summary verse:

Four rules beginning with scattering, ten rules also concerning the bowl, five rules beginning with standing up, five beginning with the head covering, five rules beginning with carrying a shoulder bag, five concerning riding such as an elephant, six beginning with a stick in the hand, and three concerning illness.

One must train not to look into the bowl of a nun who is sitting nearby in order to find fault with it. One must train not to touch a water vessel with a hand soiled with food.

One must train not to scatter food or rinse-water on a nun who is sitting nearby. One must train not to pour food-water or rinse-water into another house when a layperson sitting there has asked about the path. One must train not to pour leftover food into the bowl and carry it away. One must train not to set the bowl down on ground that has no firm base. One must train to set the bowl down where there is no cliff edge, no precipice, and no steep slope. One must train not to wash the bowl while standing. One must train to wash the bowl where there is no cliff edge, no precipice, and no steep slope. One must train not to draw water from the bowl from a swift-running stream by turning against the current. One must train not to teach the Dharma while standing to someone who is sitting and is not ill. One must train not to teach the Dharma while sitting to someone who is lying down and is not ill. One must train not to teach the Dharma while sitting on a low seat to someone who is not ill and who is seated on a high seat. One must train not to walk in front of someone who is not ill and to teach the Dharma while walking behind them. One must train to walk to the side of the path and not to teach the Dharma while walking along the path to someone who is not ill and walking on it. One must train not to teach the Dharma to someone who is not ill and who has

their head covered, who is wearing a turban, who has a shawl wrapped around them, who has their garment folded over one shoulder, or who has it folded back over the other shoulder. One must train not to teach the Dharma to someone who is not ill and who has their hair twisted up in a knot, who is wearing a hat, who wears a crown, who wears a garland on their head, or who has their head wrapped. One must train not to teach the Dharma to someone who is not ill and who is riding an elephant, riding a horse, sitting in a palanquin, sitting on top of a mount, or wearing sandals. One must train not to teach the Dharma to someone who is not ill and who is holding a staff in hand, holding a parasol in hand, holding a weapon in hand, holding a sword in hand, holding armaments in hand, or wearing armor. One must train not to urinate or defecate while standing when one is not ill. One must train not to throw urine or feces, spittle, mucus, vomit, or phlegm into water when one is not ill. Except in the case of harm arising, one must train not to climb a tree higher than one can reach with one's hand.

Noble ones, I have now set forth these many rules for training. I now ask the noble ones: are you pure in all this? I ask a second and a third time: are you pure in all this? The noble ones are pure in this; since nothing at all is said, so it is understood.

Summary verse:

Direct perception, mindfulness,
non-intoxication — and likewise
the many in their essential nature,
the spreading of grass, and
what should also be accepted.

Noble ones, these seven rules for settling disputes arise from the recitation of the Prātimokṣa Sūtra (the individual liberation sūtra), which is chanted twice a month. To one who is fit to be disciplined by direct confrontation, the discipline of direct confrontation is given. To one who is fit to be disciplined by recollection, the discipline of recollection is given. To one who is fit to be disciplined by a declaration of non-madness, the discipline of non-madness is given. To one for whom it is fitting to give many grass-blades, many grass-blades are given. To one for whom it is fitting to have their essential nature investigated, the investigation of their essential nature is given. To one for whom the spreading of grass is fitting, the spreading of grass is given. To one for whom acceptance is fitting, acceptance is given. When disputes have

arisen, they are to be settled, pacified, and fully resolved in accordance with these seven rules for settling disputes, in keeping with the Dharma, the Vinaya, and the Teacher's teaching.

Noble ones, I have now set forth these seven rules for settling disputes. I now ask the noble ones: are you pure in all this?

Are you pure in all this? This question is asked a second and a third time. If the noble ones are pure in all this, they remain silent, and that silence is taken as assent.

Noble ones, I have now set forth the preamble for the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra. The eight rules entailing defeat, the twenty rules entailing a formal meeting of the Saṅgha, the thirty-three rules entailing expiation with forfeiture, the one hundred and eighty rules entailing expiation, the eleven rules requiring individual confession, the many rules of training, and the seven rules for settling disputes — all of these have now been set forth. Those included and summarized within that sūtra of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha — these are they. With regard to whatever further teachings are in accord with the Dharma that arises from elsewhere, you should practice in concord, in harmony, in joy, and without dispute, guarding the mind, mindful, and with vigilance.

Patience is the supreme austerity — forbearance is its name.

The victors declare nirvāṇa to be the highest good.

One who has gone forth and harms another,
who injures another, is no true renunciant.

Let those who exist as sighted beings,
tend to themselves as they truly are.
In this world that the wise sustain with life,
abandon all that is wicked.

Speak no slander, do no harm.
Be restrained according to the Prātimokṣa.
Know moderation in food.
Dwell in remote and solitary places.
Apply yourself rightly to the higher mind.
This is the teaching of the buddhas.

Just as a bee, without harming
the color or fragrance of a flower,

draws only the nectar and flies away,
so let the Sage move through a village.

One should examine what is fitting and what is not —
not looking to the discord of others,
not to what others have done or left undone.
Be diligent in the higher mind
and train in the rules of training given by the Sage.
The protector who is ever mindful of quiescence
is one who has gone beyond sorrow.

Through generosity, merit grows abundantly.
Through good restraint, one does not become a foe.
One who possesses virtue abandons wrong.
Through the exhaustion of afflictions, one passes into nirvāṇa.

Commit none of the wicked deeds.
Practice virtue in its fullness.
Tame one's own mind completely.
This is the teaching of the buddhas.

Restraint of body is good.
Restraint of speech is good.
Restraint of mind is likewise good.
Restraint in all respects is good.
The monk who is restrained in all things
is thoroughly liberated from all suffering.

Guard one's words, and thoroughly restrain the mind.
Commit no non-virtue with the body.
If one purifies these ten paths of action,
one will attain the path taught by the sages.

The buddha Vipāśyin, who protects all with his uṣṇīṣa,
Śikhin who destroys cyclic existence, Viśvabhū of golden light,
Krakucchanda, Kanakamuni, Kāśyapa,
and Śākyamuni Gautama, god of gods —
he who guides the untamed, who is unsurpassed,
the protector of the world, the supreme refuge,
these seven courageous buddhas, the renowned ones —
their individual liberation has now been set forth in full.

The buddhas themselves, and whoever among the śrāvakas of the buddhas are devoted to this — through devotion to this, may you attain the unconditioned. Undertake it, give rise to it, enter into the teaching of the buddhas. Like a great elephant at a house made of reeds, crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever practices this Dharma-Vinaya with thorough vigilance, having fully abandoned the cycle of birth, will make an end of suffering.

In order to guard moral discipline toward one another and to cause the teaching to flourish, this Prātimokṣa has been recited, and the Saṅgha has performed the restoration ceremony.

For the sake of which the sūtra was recited, and for the sake of which the restoration ceremony was performed —

That moral discipline is to be guarded
just as the tip of a yak's tail is guarded.
May whatever merit has been accomplished
through the recitation of the Prātimokṣa
cause all the world without exception
to attain the rank of the Mighty Sage (the Buddha).

The Sūtra of the Prātimokṣa for Nuns is complete.

By the command of the sovereign holy lord, the glorious divine king Lha Btsan-po, this text was translated and edited and definitively established by the master Jina-mitra, holder of the Vinaya of the Sarvāstivāda school of the noble tradition, who was a specialist of the Vaibhāṣika school, together with the great editor and translator Cog-ro Klu'i-rgyal-mtshan.

Translator's Notes

- The verse "When I have passed into nirvāṇa, this shall be your Teacher" is a well-known canonical declaration attributed to the Buddha regarding the Prātimokṣa as his substitute after his parinirvāṇa. The attribution "the Self-Arisen One" in that stanza refers to the Buddha himself, using an epithet more commonly associated with Brahmā in other contexts; here it functions as a distinctive honorific for the Buddha in this liturgical framing.

The phrase rendered "market-treasury of training, the trading-house of the community of monks" uses mercantile metaphors present in the Tibetan, somewhat unusual doctrinally but clearly intentional as a literary device praising the Prātimokṣa's value.

- The verse "with ten fingers joined" through "hundredfold fitting nail" is a mnemonic gāthā presenting the Prātimokṣa as a sharp peg or nail that curbs the wandering mind. The image of the "sharp, hundredfold fitting nail" (mthun pa gzer rnon brgya pa) is a traditional simile for the

restraining force of the Prātimokṣa rules on a wandering mind compared to a horse difficult to bridle.

The summary verse at the close names the eight pārājika (defeat) rules for nuns. The identifications "child of a sākha," "perfume-selling youth," and "person born of a slave" are compressed allusions to three of the eight specific rules unique to the bhikṣuṇī Prātimokṣa; their precise referents depend on the full narrative context of each rule and may vary slightly across Vinaya traditions.

- The eighth defeat rule is left deliberately incomplete, as the Tibetan passage itself breaks off mid-sentence with the words addressed to the suspended monk. This is a continuation passage and the rule concludes in the subsequent text.

The phrase rendered "the conceit of pride" translates a technical term indicating a specific form of arrogance or presumption, namely the mistaken self-regard that leads one to overclaim spiritual attainments. The reading here follows the standard Vinaya commentarial understanding: the offence is the false claim itself, not mere proud boasting, and the exception for "conceit of pride" is a standard Vinaya qualifier distinguishing a pārājika from a lesser offence in certain edge cases.

The phrase translated as "the supremely excellent qualities of a human being — whether noble attainment, realization, knowledge, vision, or meditative experience" renders the technical Vinaya term for superhuman states, specifically the higher spiritual attainments such as the four dhyānas, noble paths and fruits, and so forth, which it is a pārājika offence to falsely claim.

- The term translated as "net" is uncertain in this Vinaya context; it may refer to a straining cloth used to filter water, a standard item of monastic equipment. The rendering follows the literal sense.

The "summary verse" at the close is a brief mnemonic gāthā listing the eight defeat rules; the numbered items in the verse do not correspond one-to-one to the full rules recited, but serve as a condensed aide-mémoire in the original Vinaya recitation tradition.

- The summary verse is a mnemonic gāthā listing the topics of the rules that precede and follow it, as is standard in Vinaya texts of this kind. The phrase rendered "taking the belongings of the dead" refers to appropriating the estate of a deceased person, a recognized Vinaya category. The phrase rendered "not that one's own part" translates a Vinaya technical expression for a charge that does not properly apply to the accused, i.e., a fabricated or misapplied accusation. The rule about "not ordaining a woman released by a consenting group and approved by the king" reflects the dual-Saṅgha ordination procedure for nuns and royal authorization as required in this Vinaya tradition.

- The compound rendered as "siding with factions, frivolous distraction, and coarse, disruptive conduct" translates three Tibetan terms: རྒྱུ་མཉམ་པ་ལྟར་ (taking sides or forming factions), རྒྱུ་མཉམ་པ་ལྟར་ (flightiness or frivolous distraction), and རྒྱུ་མཉམ་པ་ལྟར་ (coarseness or unruly behavior). These are standard Vinaya categories for communally disruptive conduct, though the precise Sanskrit equivalents in the source Vinaya are not specified in this portion of the text.

- The phrase rendered "taking sides, distraction and confusion, and harsh and disruptive conduct" translates three compound terms describing the misconduct of nuns dwelling together in a group. The first, literally "leaning on a side-support," refers to factionalism or partiality; the second, "being lifted and scattered," refers to frivolous or distracted behavior; the third, "being rough and disheveled," refers to quarrelsome or coarse conduct. These are standard Vinaya categories of communal disorder.

The final paragraph breaks off mid-instruction, as the Tibetan passage itself ends at that point before the full admonition is given; the continuation would follow in the next passage.

ornamentation whose precise identity is uncertain in context; it may be a decorative ear ornament associated with a rule about adornment.

The expression "source-beings" renders a Tibetan term referring to elemental beings or spirits inhabiting natural features; the sense is of living creatures dwelling in particular locations whose habitats must not be destroyed.

The phrase "making what remains into surplus" is a technical Vinaya expression for a formal procedure by which a monastic declares leftover food as surplus, thereby rendering it permissible to accept or consume further food; without this declaration, taking additional food after having eaten is a transgression.

- The summary verse in this section is a mnemonic listing topics covered by the rules that follow or have just been given. The verse items — comfort, fire, intention, one not fully ordained, Dharma-teaching, novice, changing appearance, precious things, the hot season — correspond to forthcoming or preceding rules and are not themselves fully expanded in this passage; this is standard Vinaya verse format.

The term rendered "obstructing factors" translates *bar du gcod pa'i chos*, literally "Dharma-factors that cut off / obstruct," a technical Vinaya category referring to actions or conditions that interrupt or obstruct monastic practice or the spiritual path. The nun's heterodox claim is that using such items does not actually cause obstruction, which the text treats as a serious wrong view meriting formal triple admonition.

- The final sentence is incomplete in the source passage, breaking off mid-enumeration of the permitted bathing seasons. This is a textual lacuna; no meaning has been supplied beyond what the Tibetan gives.

The phrase rendered "altered in three ways as regards its color" reflects the Vinaya rule requiring that new robes be marked or dyed to distinguish them from lay clothing; the three colors listed are the standard options in this Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya context.

- The term "*mātṛkā*" renders "མ་རྟོག་ཀློང་མཛུགས་ཀྱི་མཛུགས་" and refers to those who hold the *mātṛkā*, that is, the Abhidharma or its matrix texts, a standard triad alongside *sūtra* and Vinaya in Vinaya literature.

The phrase "*saṃghāvaśeṣa* offense" renders "མཐུག་པོའི་མཛུགས་ཀྱི་མཛུགས་," the technical Vinaya term for offenses requiring formal Saṃgha procedure for rehabilitation.

The final half-verse is deliberately left incomplete as it clearly continues into the next passage.

- The dimension passages present significant technical difficulty. The Tibetan employs the Sugata's finger-width and the Sugata's height as standard Vinaya units of measure, following standard Indian Buddhist monastic convention. The phrase rendered "one full Sugata's height is to be used for the padding" for the cushion is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and may refer to the total material used for stuffing rather than an additional dimensional measure.

The summary verses are mnemonic lists of rule headings rather than continuous sense; some items in the verses are only partially recoverable without access to the full rule sequence they abbreviate. The items rendered represent the most plausible reconstruction based on context.

- The term rendered "shackled" translates a Tibetan word meaning bound or fettered, likely referring to a woman under legal constraint, debt bondage, or servitude — the precise social category intended is uncertain, but some form of unfree status is clear.

The summary verse at the midpoint of the passage is tightly compressed and its terms correspond to the expanded rules that follow it, so the translation mirrors the sequence of the subsequent rules for clarity. The verse on "fish sauce" and bodily matters describes rules of personal hygiene and conduct involving a nun's private bathing vessel; "something intended

for her use" renders a term for such a vessel or container throughout.

- The summary verses are mnemonic verse-summaries of the rules that follow them, a standard Vinaya literary device. They compress multiple rules into a single verse for memorization; the individual rules then spell out each item in full. The verses do not always expand with a one-to-one correspondence in immediately obvious sequence, and some terms in the verses are elliptical shorthand for the full rule.

The phrase rendered "wound-bandaging" refers to a nun untying bandages from wounds by deceptive means, as the subsequent rule makes clear.

"Bathing with hands joined" likely refers to a particular ritual or social bathing posture that was considered inappropriately intimate or immodest; the exact social context is not entirely certain from the text alone.

"Female wanderer" renders kun du rgyu mo, a female wandering ascetic or mendicant of non-Buddhist or unaffiliated groups.

- The phrase rendered "a poor candidate" for ordination translates a term that literally refers to someone who is impoverished or indigent; in the Vinaya context this likely refers to a candidate who lacks the requisite material qualifications or provisions for the ordination ceremony. The exact technical sense may vary across Vinaya traditions.

The verse "leaving disputes to dissolve on their own" renders a phrase suggesting willful abandonment of conflict resolution when one has the capacity to act; this is understood as a transgression of communal responsibility.

- The summary verse listing "one hundred and eight" rules not shared with monks and "seventy-two" shared ones totaling "one hundred and eighty" reflects the traditional Tibetan Mūlasarvāstivāda bhikṣuṇī Prātimokṣa enumeration; the numbers are given directly in the Tibetan and are preserved as stated without adjustment.

The phrase rendered "not having looked through the crack in a wall" refers to the Vinaya rule requiring a nun to check that no living creatures or persons are present before disposing of bodily waste; the Tibetan idiom is literal and the translation preserves it.

The expression "opening the occasion" for the rule on inquiring reflects the Vinaya procedure of formally announcing that the assembly is ready to receive questions before a nun may put forward a query; this is a standard Vinaya technical act.

- The summary verses are mnemonic gathas enumerating the rules treated in each section; they function as numerical tags rather than full prose statements, and their compressed grammatical form is intentional. Several items in these lists, such as the specific postures and bodily behaviors, follow standard Vinaya formulae found across Sanskrit and Pali parallels. The similes for improper ways of wearing the lower robe (elephant trunk, palm leaf, grain stalk, snake's spread hood) are well-attested in Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya literature. The phrase rendered as "not receiving it in disconnected pieces or all at once" translates a technical distinction in monastic meal etiquette that is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the reading is consistent with parallel Vinaya passages.

- The seven rules for settling disputes correspond to the seven adhikaraṇaśamatha procedures of the Vinaya. The summary verse is highly compressed and elliptical, naming each procedure by a brief epithet; the renderings given reflect the standard Vinaya categories: direct confrontation (sammukhavinaya), recollection (smṛtivinaya), non-madness (amūḍhavinaya), the verdict of the majority (many grass-blades, i.e., the yebhuyyasikā procedure), investigation of essential nature (tatsvabhāvaiṣyā, applied to those feigning madness), spreading of grass (tṛṇastāraka, a mutual covering-over of offenses), and acceptance (pratijñāpakaraṇa). The phrase rendered "many in their essential nature" in the verse refers to the yebhuyyasikā and

tatsvabhāvaiṣyā procedures respectively, and the compression makes exact one-to-one mapping in the verse itself genuinely ambiguous.

- The epithets of the seven past buddhas in the penultimate verse section require careful handling. The Tibetan names rendered here are: འཕྲེ་ཤེས་པ་ as Vipāśyin, འཕྲེ་ཤེས་པ་ as uṣṇīṣa, སྐྱི་ཁྱི་ as Śikhin, ཀའ་ཁྱེ་མེ་ as Kanakamuni, ཀའ་ཁྱེ་མེ་ as Kāśyapa — though in context ཀའ་ཁྱེ་མེ་ may refer to Krakucchanda and the line division between the seven buddhas' epithets is compressed in the Tibetan, making individual attribution somewhat ambiguous. The listing follows the standard canonical sequence of the seven buddhas of antiquity.

The final two lines of the passage are clearly transitional colophon verses and are left open-ended as they appear incomplete in the source.

- The phrase rendered "the Mighty Sage" translates *Thub-dbang*, literally "Lord of Sages" or "Powerful Sage," a standard epithet of Śākyamuni; the aspiration is that all beings attain buddhahood. The colophon identifies this as a Sarvāstivāda Vinaya text translated under imperial Tibetan patronage, with *Jina-mitra* specified as a *Vaibhāṣika* master — a significant doctrinal detail, as the *Vaibhāṣika* is the philosophical school associated with the Sarvāstivāda Vinaya tradition. The royal name *Lha Btsan-po* in the colophon likely refers to a Tibetan emperor of the imperial period, though the precise identification is uncertain and not consequential to the translation itself.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.